

Manufacturing subsidy scheme may undergo revision

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's agenda of 'Make in India' has inspired the country and it is attracting attention from across the globe. Now the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) has proposed that the electronics manufacturing subsidy scheme be revised to become more investor-friendly.

Modified Special Incentive Package Scheme (MSIPS) includes consumer durables, which is expected to attract big-ticket investments in the country. There are several big names like Panasonic, Samsung and Videocon which have already approached DeitY for the incentives that are offered to electronics manufacturers. DeitY is seeking industry's inputs on the revised draft of the policy, which was notified in 2012 and may expire in July 2015. An official said the policy may get an extension for three more years. He added, "The procedure is also being streamlined to reduce delay in processing of the applications plus the (investment) thresholds have been rationalised and additional verticals are being added."

The new added verticals are nuclear fuel cells, smart cards, capital equipment and white goods. A research paper by Consumer Electronics and Appliances Manufacturers Association and APCO Worldwide reveals that the total investment proposals under MSIPS are worth over 700,000 million rupees. However, as the paper noted, "Though it is a positive start, the policy needs 'incremental modifications' to attract much more investments." Senior director of APCO Worldwide Rameesh Kailasam thinks that, consumer electronics is the largest and the fastest growing manufacturing industry in the world.

The revised policy also proposes that Central taxes and duties be reim-

Animesh Sahay appointed senior director in CA Technologies

CA Technologies has appointment industry veteran, Animesh Sahay, as senior director of sales to lead its Enterprise and Telecom businesses in India. He brings with him more than 18 years of experience in the IT and communication industries. His charter includes ensuring the active participation of CA's global and Indian SI partners to maximise sales in India.

Analog Devices appoints Karthik Sankaran as GM

Analog Devices, a global leader in high-performance semiconductors for signal-processing applications, has appointed Dr Karthik Sankaran as general manager of the Embedded System Products and Technology (ESPT) group. He has more than 25 years of industry experience in areas spanning chip design, software development and management.

Aejaz Mir joins Syska

Aejaz Mir has joined Shree Sant Kripa-Led Lights Pvt Ltd, the flagship company of the dynamic brand Syska Led, as senior manager for Kashmir region. He holds vast experience in marketing and brand management, having worked with several MNCs in his career so far.

bursed for categories like solar cells, nano electronic components, chip components and discrete semiconductors. The Digital India project looks forward to a net import-export balance of electronics by 2020.

MNRE planning to support large PV projects

The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has revealed a draft policy outlining a program to launch 25 new solar parks within next five years. It will support 20GW of large PV projects, with each park having capacity of 500 to 1000MW.

Considering the success of Gujarat's Charanka Solar Park, the policy emphasises partnerships with other state governments as well. States would allot the land and arrange the infrastructure for establishment of solar parks. Besides, the states would buy at least 20 per cent of the electricity from the projects.

In return, MNRE would contribute up to \$33,000 per MW or

30 per cent of the setting up cost of the solar parks as well as contribute \$41,000 per park for related expenses. As estimated by MNRE, total cost of programs and the processing fee to Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) will add up to \$665 million.

As per program, the state governments and the Central government's SECI will be termed as the developers. It also involves an option for the private developers to partner with the state governments and/or SECI, wherein the share of government entity would be 51 per cent of the equity.

Electronics Policy 2014-2020 unveiled by AP government

The Andhra Pradesh government has



Solar PV project